

THE 6 DOLLAR HEAT BATTERY BY YOUR BED

Charge a bucket of water on the wood stove in the evening. It keeps warming your bedroom for hours after the fire is dead.

Heat the water on the wood stove, pour it into a 5 gallon bucket, snap the lid on, and set it by the bed. When the fire dies around one in the morning, that bucket is still hotter than a hot bath, and it spends the rest of the night handing its heat to the room.

WHY THE HOURS BEFORE DAWN

10 or 11 PM	Plenty of people load the stove one last time.
1 or 2 AM	On a lot of stoves, that load is down to coals. The house starts leaking its heat outside.
4 or 5 AM	Your core temperature hits its overnight low. The outside air bottoms out around sunrise. You're asleep for all of it.
13,000+	Hypothermia deaths the CDC counted in the United States, 2003 to 2013. That's over 1,200 a year, highest past age 65.
About 1 in 3	Wisconsin's 2014 cases found indoors. Some of those homes had furnaces that weren't running.

The deadly mistake: every winter storm, somebody runs a generator in the garage or brings a charcoal grill inside. Carbon monoxide from those kills hundreds of Americans a year. A bucket of hot water burns nothing, so it can't poison anyone.

Need it less? If your stove holds a fire till dawn, you need this less. If it's coals by two, the bedroom's on its own until morning.



The lidded bucket on a towel, beside the nightstand, out of the path to the door.

SHOPPING LIST

- ☐ **5 gallon bucket with a lid:** about 6 dollars. New, or one that's only ever held water.
- ☐ **Digital kitchen thermometer:** about 8 dollars. The one part you shouldn't skip.
- ☐ **Two 12 quart stock pots** with lids. They split the 5 gallons into loads you can handle.
- ☐ **A lidded pitcher** that holds a gallon or so.
- ☐ **Rubber hot water bottle** (2 liter) with a cover, plus a funnel.
- ☐ **A folded towel** for under the bucket, a folded blanket for a second bucket.
- ☐ **Optional:** a second bucket. Two buckets and two lids run about 11 dollars new at the big orange store.
- ☐ **Optional:** an indoor thermometer with a low temperature memory, about 10 dollars.

WHERE HEAT ACTUALLY LIVES

86 lb	Air in a 12 by 12 bedroom with an 8 foot ceiling. Air is barely stuff.
42 lb	Water in one 5 gallon bucket.
About 1/4	How much heat a pound of air soaks up per degree, compared with a pound of water.
About 2x	One bucket holds roughly twice as much heat per degree as all the air in that room.
90° head start	Water at 150°F in a 60°F room. Nobody can fill a bedroom with 150 degree air and sleep in it.
About 1,100 Wh	Heat stored by that head start. A power station like the EcoFlow Delta 3 Classic stores about 1,000 Wh for around 450 dollars.

WHY WATER, NOT SAND OR BRICK

- ☐ A pound of water holds about 5 times as much heat per degree as a pound of dry sand. Brick and rock land around a fifth of water too.
- ☐ Water stirs itself: warm water rises, cool water sinks, so the whole bucket stays close to one temperature. Sand gives up heat only as fast as it conducts, which is slowly.
- ☐ Sand's one advantage: you can heat it far past boiling, and water stops at 212°F. Sand belongs in a steel drum. Water belongs in a bucket.



Two lidded pots of plain water on the stove top, thermometer in, pitcher ready.

CHARGE IT ON THE STOVE

- ☐ Put the two pots on the stove top **early in the evening**, while you're still feeding the fire. No flat top? A kitchen range does the same job.
- ☐ Keep a lid **resting loose** on each pot. Never latch or seal anything while it's on the heat.
- ☐ Heat to **140 to 150°F**. Check it with the thermometer.
- ☐ At 150, slide the pots to the cool edge of the stove or onto a trivet. One overshoot? Stir in a quart of cold water.

About 1,200 Wh To lift 5 gallons of winter tap water (often 40 or 50°F) up to 150°F. An hour or two on a hot stove top, longer on a lazy fire.

WHY STOP AT 150°F

The plastic: a standard bucket is high density polyethylene. It handles 150 degree water with no trouble, but it softens if you leave boiling water in it.

Your skin: at 140°F, water gives an adult a serious burn in about 5 seconds. At 150°F, about 2 seconds.

MOVE IT SAFELY

- 1 Set the **empty** bucket first: against the wall on the far side of the nightstand, out of the path to the door, on a folded towel.
- 2 Kids and pets out of the room while you pour.
- 3 Never carry a full pot down a hallway. Move the water in the lidded pitcher, a gallon or so at a time, **lid on for every trip**. Five or six trips. Keep your feet clear.
- 4 Pour slowly down the inside wall of the bucket.
- 5 Before the last of the water goes in, fill the hot water bottle.
- 6 Snap the bucket's lid on. The water's cooling now, not heating, so a closed lid is safe.
- 7 Close the bedroom door. The heat only counts if it stays in the room you sleep in.

Why the lid: one pound of water turning to vapor takes as much heat as cooling the whole bucket by 23 degrees. An open bucket fogs the window and runs down faster.

THE DISCHARGE CURVE

Calculated figures for a bare plastic bucket on a floor, 150°F water, 60°F bedroom.

First hour	Roughly 200 watts, about what three sleeping adults put out.
4 hours	Water near 100°F, giving off about 100 watts.
8 hours	Down near 80°F, still adding about 40 watts.
Whole night	About 900 of its 1,100 Wh come back. That averages a little over 100 watts.

A NIGHT, FILLED AT TEN

1 AM	Fire's out. Water around 110°F, about 120 watts.
4 AM	High 80s, about 65 watts.
7 AM	Mid 70s, still adding a trickle. Pour it back in the pots and tomorrow's charge starts 20 or 30 degrees ahead.

GET MORE FROM IT

- ☐ **Two buckets:** leave one bare so it warms the room right away. Wrap the second in a folded blanket so it saves heat for the hours before dawn. Two buckets need two charges on the stove.
- ☐ Hang a heavy blanket over the window at night. Glass leaks far more heat than a wall.
- ☐ Roll a towel along the bottom of the door.
- ☐ **Be honest about size:** it won't hold a bedroom at 68 against a January night. It slows the fall. For one bucket in a small, closed room, the math predicts a few degrees.

MEASURE IT YOURSELF

- ☐ Put the low memory thermometer on the nightstand. Run a normal night.
- ☐ Run the same night with the buckets.
- ☐ The gap between the two morning lows is your number.



The covered bottle warms the bed first. It comes out before you climb in.

WARM THE BED FAST

- 1 Fill the bottle from a pot with a funnel, **two thirds full**.
- 2 Squeeze the air out and cap it tight.
- 3 Hot water, never boiling, and always use a cover.
- 4 Warm the bed first, then **take it out before you climb in**. Never sleep on top of one.

About 70 W What a person gives off while asleep.

About 45 Wh Held above body temperature by two thirds of a 2 liter bottle at 150°F. Most of an hour of your own output, trapped under the covers.

SAFETY RULES. NOT OPTIONAL.

- ☐ **Never latch or seal a container on the heat.** Steam builds pressure until the container fails, and it fails all at once.
- ☐ **Stop at 150°F.** 140°F burns an adult seriously in about 5 seconds, 150°F in about 2.
- ☐ **Kids and pets out while you pour, lid on all night,** bucket where kids can't reach. The Consumer Product Safety Commission has warned for decades: a toddler can pull up on a 5 gallon bucket's rim, tip in headfirst, and drown. With hot water, it can scald first.
- ☐ Only use a new bucket, or one that's only held water. A paint or chemical bucket gives off fumes when hot.
- ☐ Keep buckets away from bedding and anything electrical. Never set one on a heater or a stove.
- ☐ **No hot water bottle** for babies or young children, older people with thin skin, or anyone with reduced feeling, like many people with diabetes. For them, the bucket in the room is the safer half of this build.
- ☐ Bottle burns are slow: long contact at a temperature that feels fine. Warm the bed, then remove it.
- ☐ **Never** run a generator in the garage or bring a charcoal grill inside for heat.

NEXT STEP

One bucket gets you a warmer bedroom and a warm bed. It won't heat a house. For that you need a material you can heat far past boiling, and that's sand: watch the 300 dollar sand drum video next.

Watch the full video: youtube.com/@SketchySurvival101

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